- Your operations are slowed by data not being easily findable or accessible by consumers.
- Your data consumers spend too long aligning with software and/or data engineering teams.
- Your central data team has an arm-long backlog of problems to deal with (e.g., maintenance of data models and catalogs, deciding on access rights, or costs of to-and-fro data transfer).

If any of these issues apply (but only to a minor degree; or if the inconveniences they cause are not significant), data mesh is less likely to be a worthwhile investment. However, suppose that you observe any combination of the previously mentioned problems in your company. Additionally, suppose that your organization has a strong business reason for needing a data mesh, including to derive value from data, a complex socio-technical architecture, complex data needs, or requiring scalability for planned growth. In that case, the chances that data mesh will be right for you are high. However, to make the final decision, you should not only understand what the expected final effect could bring but also what the journey would entail.

2.2 Data mesh alternatives and complementary solutions

Solutions described in this section can be considered as either complements or alternatives to a data mesh. This depends on whether we look at them as technology or socio-technical architecture, respectively. Therefore, we will describe popular patterns and architectures not only from a technical perspective, as it is usually done, but also from a socio-technical one.

We hope that this discussion will help you decide whether any of these solutions is sufficient for your organization’s needs. You can also select them as technologies to be used as elements of your data mesh.